

South Africa

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** April 27, 1994 **Usage:** National and Civil

The overall design conveys convergence and unification
Yellow, black, and green are taken from the ANC flag



Red, white, and blue are taken from the colors of the Boer republics

Africa



The Union of **South Africa** was formed in 1910 and the republic in 1961. In 1994 a democratic, multi-racial constitution was adopted.

South Africa had no distinctive flag until 1928 when a national flag was adopted based on the orange, white, and blue tricolor used by the first Dutch settlers, with three smaller flags in the center for Britain, Transvaal, and the Orange Free State.

A NEW FLAG FOR A NEW ERA

When a multi-racial democracy came into prospect, attempts were made to

find a new flag and the present design, created by the Chief Herald of South Africa, was adopted. The new South African flag combines the colors of the Boer republics, with those of the African National Congress (ANC), whose flag was adopted in 1917. The Y-shape represents the convergence of old traditions with new and the progress of the united state into the future.

ARMS OF SOUTH AFRICA

Tusks are for strength and eternity

Motto is in the earliest known (though now extinct) language in South Africa; it translates as "Diverse People Unite"



The secretary bird spreads its wings to show the ascent of the nation

The weapons of war symbolize defense, but are laid down, symbolizing peace